

CULVERTCRAWL · DESIGN DECISION RECORD

CulvertCrawl TRL 2 review decisions

Open Hardware Portfolio · amishchadha.com

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Document ID	CVC-DDR-001	Version	0.1
Status	Draft	Date	2026-09-25
Author	Amish Chadha	License	CERN-OHL-S-2.0
Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
Repository	github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/culvertcrawl		
Source	docs/decisions/0001-trl2-review-decisions.md @ uncommitted		

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.1	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	Record Amish's 2026-09-25 decisions on the TRL 2 review

0001: TRL 2 review decisions

- **Date:** 2026-09-25
- **Status:** accepted (items 1 to 8); items 9 to 11 remain proposed, awaiting Amish

■ Context

The TRL 2 review note (docs/REVIEW.md , session 2026-09-25, /populate) listed nine items as "Proposed, awaiting Amish", and the precis (CVC-PRC-001 v0.2) gave a recommendation for most of them. On 2026-09-25 Amish reviewed the review points for every portfolio repo and wrote: "proceed with all of your recommendations across all batches. Make sure we don't proceed to TRL 4 on any of them."

This record lists what that instruction decides and what it leaves open because there was no recommendation to accept. TRL 4 is on hold by Amish's instruction.

■ Options considered

The options for each item are in docs/REVIEW.md (TRL 2 section) and in CVC-PRC-001 v0.2, "Key design choices". They are not repeated here.

■ Decision

Table 1. Decided items.

#	Item	Decision	Where it now lives
1	Budget	Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation. Raise <code>budget_usd</code> from \$800 to \$900, keeping the 60 m wired tether and slip ring	<code>project.yaml</code> , CVC-REQ-001 R12
2	Pipe range	Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation. Keep 300 to 900 mm and check the 900 mm case early at TRL 3 (done in CVC-CAL-001: R5 not met at 900 mm)	CVC-REQ-001 R1, R5
3	Surface battery	Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation. 12.8 V 20 Ah LiFePO4 with a 48 V boost for the prototype; a SwapCell-compatible input stays a later option	CVC-PRC-001 v0.3
4	Drive	Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation. Tracks rather than wheels	CVC-PRC-001 v0.3
5	Power architecture	Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation. Surface power over the tether at 48 V DC; no battery in the crawler	CVC-PRC-001 v0.3, CVC-REQ-001 R11
6	Profiling sensor	Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation. Class 2, 520 nm laser ring ahead of a fixed fisheye camera, rather than structured light, stereo or a pan-tilt head	CVC-PRC-001 v0.3
7	Processing	Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation. Ring extraction and reports on the operator's laptop; the crawler streams video and sensor data	CVC-PRC-001 v0.3
8	Pitch and problem wording	Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation. Unchanged; the TRL 2 review recommended no rewording	<code>project.yaml</code> , <code>README.md</code>

Notes on the portfolio-wide approvals from the same instruction:

- **SwapCell.** CulvertCrawl does not use a SwapCell pack. If the later SwapCell-compatible input is taken up, it should cite SwapCell interface v0.3, whose item W (wake on a coded INTERLOCK loop, no CAN host needed) removes the CAN heartbeat concern raised at TRL 2. A shared SwapCell pack would be priced once in the SwapCell repo and excluded from this kit budget.
- **Co-design partners** are picked per area later; the first partner stays open (item 10).

Items that remain open

These had no recommendation to accept and stay **Proposed, awaiting Amish**:

1. **Output format first:** a PACP-style observation log, FHWA condition ratings or a deflection report. No preference was stated.
2. **First partner user group** for field trials (county road department, watershed group or university transportation program). Not named.
3. **Removable laser boom** for tight or bent pipes. Marked "proposed" in CVC-PRC-001 v0.2 without a recommendation.

New proposals from the TRL 3 calculations (R2, R5, R8) are listed in `docs/REVIEW.md` and are also awaiting Amish.

■ Consequences

- `project.yaml` `budget_usd` is 900. The priced BOM is \$901, so R12 is recorded as not met by \$1 (CVC-CAL-001).
- R5 keeps its 1 % target over 300 to 900 mm and is recorded as not met at 900 mm.
- CVC-PRB-001, CVC-PRC-001 and CVC-REQ-001 move to version 0.3 with these decisions recorded.
- No TRL 4 work is started.